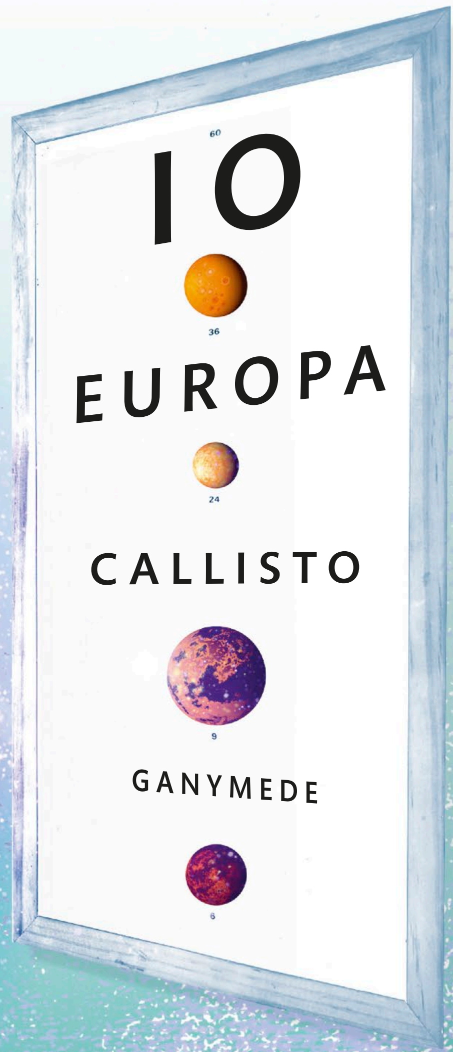
However, this claim was not popular with the Catholic Church. In 1616, Galileo was brought before the Inquisition (the Church court) and told to take back what he had said. Grudgingly, he did so. However, he went on to publish his ideas, and in 1633, he was tried again. This time, he was placed under house arrest, where he remained until he died. During that time, he returned to his work on motion. He realized that a moving object will keep moving at the same speed unless a force (such as friction) acts on it to slow it down or speed it up—this is the principle of inertia. He concluded that in a vacuum, all objects will fall at the same speed, no matter their size and weight. This revolutionized the basic laws of physics and provided the foundation for Isaac Newton's three laws of motion, which are fundamental to our understanding of the Universe.

HANS **LIPPERSHEY**

A Dutchman who made spectacles, Hans Lippershey was one of the first people to build an instrument for viewing distant objects—a telescope—but he failed to secure a patent for it.

In 1608, Lippershey (1570–1619) applied for a patent for his instrument that could magnify objects to three times the size. According to one story, he got the idea for his "looker" from two children who were playing in his shop, putting one lens in front of another. However, some said that he stole the concept from another spectacle-maker, Zacharias Janssen. Furthermore, a similar patent was filed just a few weeks after Lippershey's by Jacob Metius. Due to the dispute, the Dutch government refused both patent applications but paid Lippershey well for his design. When Galileo heard about the telescope, he made his own.



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